UNHRC

Oakridge JMUN 2026

United Nations Human Rights Council

Agenda: Role of States in Countering the Negative Impact of Disinformation on the Enjoyment and Realization of Human Rights

CAR KIA
Jubilee Hills | HiTech City | Financial District

CONTENTS

1. Letter from the Executive Board 3

2. MUN Rules Of Procedure (ROP) 4

- 1. Roll Call 4
- 2. Setting the Agenda 4
- 3. Speakers' List 4
- 4. Points 4
- 5. Motions 5
- 6. Yields 5
- 7. Caucuses 5
- 8. Draft Resolutions and Amendments 5
- 9. Voting 6

3. A Brief Introduction to the Human Rights Council 6

4. Disinformation 7

- 4.1 What Is Disinformation? 7
- 4.2 How Does Disinformation Impact the Enjoyment of Human Rights by Individuals? 8
- 4.3 What Does the Problem Look Like Today? 9

5. Further Reading 9

6. Tips for Preparation 9

1. Letter from the Executive Board

Welcome to the Background Guide (hereinafter referred to as the BG) for the Human Rights Council simulation at Oakridge Junior MUN 2026!

The purpose of a BG is to introduce participants to the topic that will be discussed at the conference. Please note that the BG is not intended to be an exhaustive or comprehensive resource; rather, it should serve as the starting point for your research.

This BG is divided into three sections. The first introduces the body in which you will represent your assigned portfolio: the Human Rights Council. The second discusses the agenda, and the final section outlines a few tips to help you prepare.

I encourage you to conduct further research beyond the information provided in this guide. If you have any questions after reading the BG, please feel free to email me.

Regards,

D. Sai Srikar
President
srikar.work13@gmail.com

Satvik Chenna
Vice-President

Vivaan Sharma
Rapporteur

2. MUN Rules Of Procedure (ROP)

1. Roll Call

- The Chair calls on each country to declare if they are "Present" or "Present and Voting." It refers to the voting procedure on the Draft Resolution, where a delegate can vote "Yes", "No", or opt to "Abstain".
- If "Present and Voting," the delegate cannot abstain from voting. If the delegate chooses to respond with "Present", they may answer with "Present and Voting" on subsequent days, but this is not permissible for "Present and Voting" as this reply must be used consistently from that point forth.

2. Setting the Agenda

- Delegates motion to set the agenda, followed by a formal debate on which topic to discuss first. This motion requires a simple majority to pass.

3. Speakers' List

- After passing a motion to enter formal debate, delegates are placed on a speakers' list to make formal speeches. Time limits are set, and the Chair calls on delegates to speak in order.
- A delegate must raise their placard if they wish to add their name to this list. They can be on this list only once on any occasion.

4. Points

- **Point of Order:** To correct a procedural error by the Chair.
- **Point of Personal Privilege:** For personal discomfort (e.g., if the room is too cold, or if a fellow delegate cannot be heard).
- **Point of Inquiry:** To ask questions about discussion or statements in committee.
- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** To ask questions with regard to the Rules of Procedure.

5. Motions

- **Motion to Suspend the Meeting:** To break for caucuses or adjourn the session.
- **Motion to Close Debate:** Ends the discussion on a topic and moves to voting. Requires a two-thirds majority.
- **Motion to Table the Topic:** Postpones debate on a topic. Requires a majority vote.

6. Yields

- **Yield to the Executive Board:** A delegate yields their remaining time from their speech to the Executive Board. It is to be used as they see fit.
- **Yield to Another Delegate:** A delegate yields their remaining time for another delegate to speak. (This delegate's permission must be sought beforehand.)
- **Yield to Points of Information:** A delegate yields their remaining time to Points of Information to the committee.
- **Yield to Comments:** A delegate yields their remaining time to comments from the committee.

7. Caucuses

- **Moderated Caucus:** The Chair controls the speaking order with shorter, focused speeches. The topic selected is a narrowed version of the agenda, chosen by the delegate who proposed the moderated caucus.
- **Unmoderated Caucus:** Informal discussion among delegates not under the moderation of the Executive Board.

8. Draft Resolutions and Amendments

- Delegates collaborate to create draft resolutions, which are formal solutions to the discussed issue.
- **Friendly Amendments:** Accepted by all sponsors without a vote.
- **Unfriendly Amendments:** Need to be voted on to be added.

9. Voting

- **Procedural Votes:** Includes motions and amendments; all members must vote.
- **Substantive Votes:** For resolutions and unfriendly amendments; only "Present and Voting" delegates may vote, and abstentions are allowed.

3. A Brief Introduction to the Human Rights Council

The United Nations is an international organization founded in 1945. It remains the one place on Earth where all the world's countries can gather together, discuss common problems, and find shared solutions that benefit all of humanity. The UN has evolved over the years to keep pace with a rapidly changing world.

The UN General Assembly (UNGA) is the main policy-making organ of the Organization. All UN Member States are members of the General Assembly. The Human Rights Council, the body which we are concerned with, was established in 2006 by the General Assembly.

The Council, unlike the General Assembly, is composed of 47 Member States. It provides a multilateral forum to address human rights violations and country situations. It responds to human rights emergencies and makes recommendations on how to better implement human rights on the ground.

Read More

Access an easy-to-read document about the Human Rights Council



Human Rights and Alliance of Civilizations Room, United Nations Office at Geneva in Switzerland

4. Disinformation

Agenda: Role of States in Countering the Negative Impact of Disinformation on the Enjoyment and Realization of Human Rights

4.1 What Is Disinformation?

While **misinformation** refers to the accidental spread of inaccurate information, **disinformation** is not only inaccurate, but intended to deceive and is spread in order to do serious harm.

Disinformation can be spread by state or non-state actors. It can affect a broad range of human rights, undermining responses to public policies or amplifying tensions in times of emergency or armed conflict.

There is no universally accepted definition of disinformation. No one definition may be sufficient on its own, given the multiple and different contexts in which concerns over disinformation may arise, including with regard to issues as diverse as electoral process, public health, armed conflicts, or climate change.

4.2 How Does Disinformation Impact the Enjoyment of Human Rights by Individuals?

Disinformation is a human rights issue because, simply put, the spread of disinformation can cause harm to a range of human rights.

- For an election to be free and fair, voters need to have accurate information about the parties, candidates and other factors when they vote. Incorrect information may influence the way that individuals vote, and there are numerous resources which highlight how the results of elections may be influenced by disinformation.
- Inaccurate information about health care and disease prevention, such as false information on risks associated with vaccines, may deter people from taking healthcare decisions that protect their health, putting them (and others) at greater risk.
- Disinformation often relates to a particular individual, particularly political and public figures, as well as journalists, and is designed to harm that person's reputation.
- Disinformation sometimes focuses on particular groups in society, such as migrants or certain ethnic groups, and is designed to incite violence, discrimination or hostility.
- However, inappropriate policy responses to disinformation can, themselves, also pose risks to human rights, particularly the right to freedom of expression.

Trying to tackle disinformation by identifying and removing all forms of information that are false and misleading is an impossible task; by casting the net so wide, it is inevitable that legitimate forms of expression will end up being removed.

A Human Rights-Based Approach

A human rights-based approach to disinformation would, by contrast, be designed and targeted towards addressing the adverse human rights impacts caused by disinformation, rather than all disinformation itself.

Read More

Read this for more details on the negative impact of disinformation on human rights

4.3 What Does the Problem Look Like Today?

Current discussions on disinformation reflect a new and rapidly evolving communications landscape, in part due to innovative technologies such as Artificial Intelligence that enable the dissemination of unparalleled volumes of content at unprecedented speeds.

Navigating this modern and qualitatively different media landscape and ensuring it advances, rather than undermines, the protection and promotion of human rights and international peace and security is a key challenge of our time.

Disinformation can have a variety of motives, including political, ideological or commercial, or a combination thereof. When used by those with power and influence, it can undermine trust in public institutions and contribute to polarizing societies and increasing social divisions.

5. Further Reading

- UNHRC resolution on countering disinformation (2026)
- UN Secretary-General report on countering disinformation (2022)
- Submission to the HRC Advisory Committee on the impact of disinformation on human rights
- About the Human Rights Council (easy-to-read document)

6. Tips for Preparation

1. **Please do not rely on Generative Artificial Intelligence (Gen AI) for your research.** Its outputs are often easy to identify. Although I will not penalise you for using Gen AI, the likelihood of your contributions to the discussion resembling those of another participant who has also used it is very high. I greatly value uniqueness and creativity, so I am willing to overlook errors in

syntax or structure if I can recognise that your speech is genuinely your own. However, I am unlikely to award a high mark to a speech that is entirely AI-generated.

2. **Avoid jumping straight into drafting your speeches immediately after reading the BG.** Take the time to research and understand your country's foreign policy (you can Google this term), its interests, its priorities, and its previous involvement with the topic at hand. Doing so will help you establish a clear direction for your interventions during the conference. You will also be able to lobby other participants (persuading them to support your policy priorities) more clearly and effectively if you understand your portfolio well.
3. **Many first-time Model UN participants mistakenly believe they are at a disadvantage if they represent a country that is not particularly popular.** This could not be further from the truth. Please include information about your country's policies, programmes, and achievements relevant to the topic in your speech. This is one of the easiest ways to make your speech unique, as no other participant has been assigned your portfolio. Remember that you are representing your assigned country, so discussing its work and priorities is essential.
4. **Avoid cramming too many ideas into your speech.** You have limited time, so use it judiciously. You will be required to deliver a speech in under 60 or 90 seconds, so choose a topic that lends itself to the time limit you have been given. A speech that explores one issue effectively is far better than one that merely touches on several. However, this does not mean you should speak too quickly to cover more information. Deliver your speech eloquently and persuasively, and practise beforehand to achieve the best results.
5. **Please use data, statistics, and evidence to support your arguments.** Including these demonstrates the extent of your research and lends credibility to your speech. Without specific details, speeches can easily become generic. However, this is not a licence to include a disproportionate amount of evidence. Every piece of evidence you use must be relevant to the circumstances and clearly linked to the claim it supports.